

FORECAST SPEAKING

THE FORUM CENTER – NGUYỄN HOÀNG HUY

TÀI LIỆU IELTS SPEAKING QUÝ 3

IELTS SPEAKING PART 2

Describe a time when you saw something in the sky (e.g. flying kites, birds, sunset, etc.)

You should say:

- What you saw
- Where and when you saw it
- How long you watched it
- And explain how you felt about the experience

Version 1

“Okay, so I’d like to talk about a really beautiful sunset I saw a couple of months ago. It’s a simple memory, but it really stuck with me.

It was a Friday evening, and I’d had a really long and stressful week at work. I was just heading home on my motorbike, crossing the Thu Thiem Bridge here in Saigon. The traffic was heavy, everyone was rushing... you know, the usual scene for a Friday.

But then I looked over and the sky was just... incredible. It was lit up with these amazing colours - deep reds, oranges, and even some purple. The sun looked like a huge orange ball slowly dropping behind the sharp outlines of the buildings. It was one of those moments that just makes you stop what you're doing.

Honestly, even with all the noise from the traffic, I just felt like I had to pull over for a minute. I found a safe spot on the walkway, and just stood there watching for maybe... 5 or 10 minutes? It wasn't long, but it felt like a proper break from everything.

And the feeling was just so calming. In the middle of that noisy, chaotic city, it was a moment of complete peace. It really lifted my mood after such a tough week. It also made me think, you know, we're always in such a rush and we often forget to just look up and appreciate the simple things.

So yeah, that sunset was more than just a nice view; it was a great reminder to slow down a bit.”

Version 2

“Alright, I’m going to talk about a camping trip I took last semester with my university’s photo club. We went to Ba Den Mountain.

At night, we hiked away from the campsite to a spot where it was completely dark, far from any city lights. And the sky was just... amazing. It was so clear you could see the Milky Way perfectly, looking like a glowing cloud of stars. It was actually my first time seeing it properly like that.

Some of my friends were busy taking special photos of the night sky, but honestly, I just lay on the grass and looked up. I remember we were pointing out star patterns... or at least trying to! We were eating instant noodles to stay warm, and the whole atmosphere was just really peaceful.

We stayed out there for a couple of hours, just talking. And it felt less about taking pictures and more about just connecting with friends, you know, under this huge, incredible sky.

That night definitely stuck with me. It was a great reminder to just slow down and appreciate moments like that. It wasn't just about the beautiful view; it was the whole experience.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
appreciate	verb	/ə'pri:ʃi.ert/	To recognize the full worth of; to be grateful for something.	Trân trọng, công nhận giá trị
atmosphere	noun	/'æt.mə.sfiər/	The mood or feeling of a place or situation.	Bầu không khí, không gian
calming	adjective	/'kɑ:m.ɪŋ/	Making someone feel relaxed and not worried.	Êm dịu, làm cho bình tĩnh
chaotic	adjective	/keɪ'ɒt.ɪk/	In a state of complete confusion and disorder.	Hỗn loạn, lộn xộn
experience	noun	/ɪk'spiə.ri.əns/	An event or occurrence which leaves an impression on someone.	Trải nghiệm, kinh nghiệm
glowing	adjective	/'gləʊ.ɪŋ/	Giving out a steady light without flame.	Rực sáng, phát sáng
incredible	adjective	/ɪn'kred.ə.bəl/	Difficult to believe; extraordinary.	Khó tin, đáng kinh ngạc, tuyệt vời
outline	noun	/'aʊt.laɪn/	A line or set of lines enclosing or indicating the shape of an object.	Đường nét, hình dáng bên ngoài
pull over	phrasal verb	/pʊl 'əʊ.vər/	To move to the side of the road and stop.	Tấp xe vào lề đường
reminder	noun	/rɪ'maɪn.dər/	Something that causes you to remember something.	Lời nhắc nhở, vật gợi nhớ
semester	noun	/sə'mes.tər/	A half-year term in a school or university.	Học kỳ
stressful	adjective	/'stres.fəl/	Causing mental or emotional stress.	Căng thẳng, áp lực

Describe a sports event that you would like to attend as part of the audience.

You should say:

- What it is
- Who you want to watch it with
- Why you want to be part of the audience
- And explain how you would feel about attending this event

Version 1

“Oh, that's an easy one for me. If I could go to any live sports event, it would have to be a football match. Specifically, an AFF Cup final between Vietnam and our biggest rival, Thailand, right here at My Dinh Stadium in Hanoi.

I'd want to go with my two best friends. We're all huge football fans and we've watched countless games on TV together, so being there in the stadium for real would be a dream come true for all of us.

The main reason I want to be in the audience is for the atmosphere. I mean, you can watch the game on a big screen, but you can never feel the energy. I imagine the stadium would be absolutely electric. Even before the match, you'd just see a sea of red flags and hear thousands of people chanting. The noise would be incredible.

And during the game, the best part would be the feeling of connection. You could be sitting next to a complete stranger, but the moment Vietnam scores a goal, you're jumping and hugging them like old friends. It's that shared passion, that feeling of unity that you just can't get anywhere else.

So, how would I feel? Honestly, I think I'd be a nervous wreck the whole time, but in a good way! And if we won... wow, the celebration would be insane. To be part of that massive celebration and share that joy with the whole country... that would be an unforgettable experience. I'd probably lose my voice from shouting, but it would be totally worth it.”

Version 2

“Okay, so if I could go to any sports event, I would definitely choose to watch the Vietnam men's football team play in a SEA Games final.

I'd want to go with my close friends from university. We've watched so many big games together on a projector in our dorm room, and we were always screaming our heads off. But I think being there live, in the stadium, would be a whole different level.

I can just imagine what the atmosphere would be like. The streets around the stadium would be a sea of red and gold. You'd have fans everywhere, waving flags, some people playing drums... The whole place would just be buzzing with excitement.

But the main reason I want to be there is for the energy inside the stadium. It must feel so powerful when tens of thousands of people start chanting together. And the moment Vietnam scores a goal... that roar from the crowd would be insane. I'd probably lose my voice from shouting, but it would be totally worth it.

For me, it's not even just about winning or losing. It's that feeling of unity, you know? Seeing thousands of strangers all connected by the same hope and passion. To be a small part of that incredible moment is something I'd love to experience at least once in my life.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
atmosphere	noun	/ˈæt.mə.sfiər/	The mood or feeling of a place or situation.	Bầu không khí
buzzing	adjective	/ˈbʌz.ɪŋ/	Filled with excitement, activity, or noise.	Sôi động, náo nhiệt
chant	verb / noun	/tʃɑːnt/	To shout or sing a word or phrase repeatedly; the phrase itself.	Hô vang, hò reo; khẩu hiệu
connection	noun	/kəˈnek.ʃən/	A feeling that you understand and are close to someone.	Sự kết nối, sự gắn kết
countless	adjective	/ˈkaʊnt.ləs/	Very many; too many to be counted.	Vô số, không đếm xuể
electric	adjective	/iˈlek.trɪk/	Very exciting and producing strong feelings.	Sôi động, náo nhiệt (đầy cảm hứng)
insane	adjective	/mˈsem/	(Informal) Extremely good, exciting, or impressive.	(Từ lóng) Điên cuồng, cuồng nhiệt, tuyệt vời
nervous wreck	idiom	/ˈnɜː.vəs rek/	A person who is extremely worried or anxious.	Người cực kỳ lo lắng, căng thẳng
passion	noun	/ˈpæʃ.ən/	A very powerful feeling of love, enthusiasm, or desire.	Niềm đam mê
powerful	adjective	/ˈpaʊə.fəl/	Having a strong effect on your thoughts or feelings.	Mạnh mẽ, đầy nội lực
rival	noun	/ˈraɪ.vəl/	A person or team competing with another for the same objective.	Đối thủ, địch thủ

roar	noun	/rɔːr/	A loud, deep sound made by a large group of people.	Tiếng gầm, tiếng reo hò vang dội
specifically	adverb	/spə'sɪf.ɪ.kəl.i/	In a detailed and exact way.	Một cách cụ thể, đặc biệt là
unforgettable	adjective	/ˌʌn.fə'get.ə.bəl/	So good, beautiful, or exciting that you will always remember it.	Không thể nào quên, đáng nhớ
unity	noun	/'juː.nə.ti/	The state of being joined together as a whole.	Sự đoàn kết, sự thống nhất
worth it	phrase	/wɜːθ ɪt/	Enjoyable or useful despite the effort, cost, or trouble.	Xứng đáng, đáng giá

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Describe a place you went to and an outdoor activity you did there.

You should say:

- **Where it was**
- **When you went there**
- **What outdoor activity you did**
- **Why you did that activity there**
- **And explain how you felt about the experience**

Version 1

“Okay, I'd like to talk about a really memorable team-building trip my company organised a few months back. We went to a place called Madagui Forest City, which is in Lam Dong province, a good few hours' drive from the hustle and bustle of Ho Chi Minh City. As a marketing manager, my job is pretty hectic, so I was really looking forward to getting away from it all.

The place itself is this huge forest park. The main event for us was ziplining across the Da Huo river. I have to admit, standing on that high platform and looking down at the river below, I was pretty nervous. I'm not exactly a daredevil, you know. But all my colleagues were cheering each other on, and there was this really great team energy, so I just decided to go for it and step out of my comfort zone.

The moment I pushed off was just an amazing rush. I was literally flying through the air, with the forest on one side and the river right below me. The feeling of freedom was incredible, and all the stress from work just seemed to melt away. We spent the rest of the day doing other fun activities like grass-skiing and hiking, surrounded by all this beautiful nature.

Honestly, it was more than just an outdoor trip; it was a fantastic bonding experience. Seeing your boss and colleagues outside of the usual office environment, all laughing and tackling challenges together, really helps the team connect better. It was a great change of pace and reminded me how important it is to disconnect from work and reconnect with nature and, of course, the people you work with.”

Version 2

“Okay, so I’d like to talk about an adventure I had during my last semester break. Me and a few of my university friends decided to hike Ba Den Mountain in Tay Ninh. Since we’re all students, we did it on a shoestring budget. We packed our own food and decided to hike the whole way up instead of taking the cable car, you know, to make it more of a challenge.

We started early in the morning to avoid the heat, but the trail was way tougher than we expected. It was really steep and rocky in some parts. Honestly, there were a few moments where I seriously thought we’d made a huge mistake! But the best part was the team spirit. We kept encouraging each other, sharing our water, and telling silly jokes to keep our spirits up. That feeling of being in it together really made the difficult parts much more manageable.

After what felt like forever, we finally made it to the summit. We were completely exhausted, but the sense of achievement was just incredible. The panoramic view from up there was absolutely breathtaking - you could see everything for miles around. We just sat down, ate the simple lunch we’d packed, and felt completely on top of the world.

Looking back, the trip was more than just a hike. It was super demanding, for sure, but it taught us a lot about perseverance and just how strong our friendship really is. It was the perfect adventure, you know, getting us off the beaten track and away from our textbooks. I honestly wouldn’t trade that memory for anything.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
breathtaking	adjective	/ˈbreθ,teɪ.kɪŋ/	Extremely beautiful or amazing.	Ngoạn mục, hấp dẫn đến nghẹt thở
colleague	noun	/ˈkɒl.iːg/	A person with whom one works in a profession or business.	Đồng nghiệp
comfort zone	idiom	/ˈkʌm.fət zəʊn/	A situation where one feels safe or at ease.	Vùng an toàn
demanding	adjective	/dɪˈmɑːn.dɪŋ/	Needing a lot of skill, patience, effort, etc.	Đòi hỏi cao, khắt khe
exhausted	adjective	/ɪɡˈzɔː.stɪd/	Extremely tired.	Kiệt sức, mệt lử
hectic	adjective	/ˈhek.tɪk/	Full of incessant or frantic activity.	Bận rộn, hối hả, tất bật
hustle and bustle	idiom	/ˈhʌs.əl ən ˈbʌs.əl/	A large amount of activity and noise.	Sự hối hả, ồn ào, nhộn nhịp
manageable	adjective	/ˈmæn.ɪ.dʒə.bəl/	Able to be dealt with or controlled.	Có thể giải quyết, kiểm soát được
memorable	adjective	/ˈmem.ər.ə.bəl/	Worth remembering or easily remembered, especially because of being special.	Đáng nhớ, không thể nào quên
off the beaten track	idiom	/ɒf ðə ˈbiː.tən træk/	In a place where few people go, far from main roads and towns.	Nơi hẻo lánh, ít người lui tới
panoramic view	noun phrase	/ˌpæn.əˈræm.ɪk vjuː/	A view of a wide area of land.	Tầm nhìn toàn cảnh
perseverance	noun	/ˌpɜː.sɪˈvɪə.rəns/	The quality of continuing to try to	Sự kiên trì, bền bỉ

			achieve a particular aim despite difficulties.	
sense of achievement	noun phrase	/sens əv ə'tʃi:v.mənt/	A proud feeling of having done something difficult and succeeded.	Cảm giác thành tựu, mãn nguyện
shoestring budget	idiom	/'ʃu:.striŋ 'bʌdʒ.ɪt/	A very small amount of money.	Ngân sách eo hẹp, ít ỏi
summit	noun	/'sʌm.ɪt/	The highest point of a hill or mountain.	Đỉnh (núi)
tackle (a challenge)	verb	/'tæk.əl/	To make determined efforts to deal with a difficult problem or task.	Giải quyết, đối mặt (với thử thách)

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Describe an outdoor sport you would like to try for the first time

You should say:

- **What the sport is**
- **When and where you would like to try it**
- **With whom you would like to do it**
- **And explain why you want to try it**

Version 1

“Okay, so a sport I’ve been wanting to try for ages is scuba diving. You know, I spend most of my week in a busy office, just staring at a screen, so the idea of being in a completely different world, somewhere totally silent and underwater... that sounds amazing to me.

If I were to do it, I'd love to go to the Con Dao islands. I've heard the water there is incredibly clear and the sea life is protected, so you can see a lot of things. But I wouldn't just jump in the water. I'd want to do it properly, so I'd definitely sign up for a proper certification course, like the PADI one. You have to learn all the theory and practice in a pool first before you go into the actual ocean. I actually like that you have to prepare carefully.

I think the main reason I want to try it is for the peace and quiet. Down there, there are no emails, no phone calls... nothing. It would force me to completely disconnect. It's just you and the sound of your own breathing. I imagine that first moment... you know, when you're actually breathing underwater and maybe you see a big sea turtle just swimming by... I think that would just be an incredible feeling. It's a feeling of wonder that we don't really get in our day-to-day lives.

So yeah, it would be a new skill to learn, but also, I think it would be like a kind of meditation for me.”

Version 2

“Okay, so there’s one sport I’m absolutely dying to try, and that's surfing. I’ve seen so many videos of it, and it just looks so... free, you know? It seems like a perfect mix of being a physical challenge and a great way to connect with nature.

I'd love to go somewhere like My Khe Beach in Da Nang to learn. It's famous for having good waves and a really cool, young vibe. My plan would be to go with a few of my university friends during the summer break, and we'd all sign up for a surf camp together. I think learning in a group would be way more fun. We could motivate each other, especially since we’re definitely going to wipe out a hundred times! I know it has a steep learning curve, but that’s part of what makes it exciting.

The reason I want to try it isn't just about standing on the board. It's the whole lifestyle that seems so cool. Like, the patience you need to wait for the perfect wave, and then the excitement when you finally catch it... and that amazing feeling of just gliding across the water. You know, as a student, I'm stuck indoors studying a lot, so the idea of spending a whole day at the beach, being active, and just focusing on one thing... that sounds incredible.

So yeah, it’s a challenge, it's active, and it would just be an awesome story to tell. For me, it’s pretty much the coolest sport out there.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
certification course	noun phrase	/,sɜː.tɪ.fɪ'keɪ.ʃən kɔːs/	A program of study that provides you with an official document as proof of a particular skill or standard.	Khóa học cấp chứng chỉ
day-to-day	adjective	/,deɪ.tə'deɪ/	Happening every day as a regular part of your life or work.	Thường ngày, hàng ngày
disconnect	verb	/,dɪs.kə'nekt/	To stop being involved with or connected to something.	Ngắt kết nối, tạm gác lại
dying to do sth	idiom	/'daɪ.ɪŋ tə duː/	To be extremely eager to have or do something.	Rất muốn, khao khát làm gì đó
gliding	verb	/'ɡlaɪ.dɪŋ/	To move easily without stopping and without effort or noise.	Lướt đi (một cách nhẹ nhàng)
lifestyle	noun	/'laɪf.staɪl/	The way in which a person or group lives.	Lối sống, phong cách sống
meditation	noun	/,med.ɪ'teɪ.ʃən/	The practice of focusing your mind in silence, especially for religious or spiritual purposes, or to relax.	Thiền định
motivate	verb	/'məʊ.tɪ.veɪt/	To make someone want to do something well.	Thúc đẩy, tạo động lực
patience	noun	/'peɪ.ʃəns/	The ability to wait, or to continue doing something despite difficulties.	Sự kiên nhẫn
physical challenge	noun phrase	/'fɪz.ɪ.kəl 'tʃæl.ɪndʒ/	A task or situation that tests someone's physical abilities.	Thử thách về thể chất

protected	adjective	/prə'tek.tɪd/	Kept safe from injury, damage, or loss.	Được bảo vệ, được bảo tồn
steep learning curve	idiom	/sti:p 'lɜːnɪŋ kɜːv/	A situation in which someone has to learn a lot in a short period of time.	Quá trình học hỏi khó khăn ban đầu
theory	noun	/'θiə.ri/	A formal set of ideas that is intended to explain why something happens.	Lý thuyết
vibe	noun	/vaɪb/	(Informal) The mood or character of a place, situation, or piece of music.	(Từ lóng) Bầu không khí, cảm giác
wipe out	phrasal verb	/waɪp aʊt/	(Informal, surfing) To fall off a surfboard.	Ngã (khỏi ván lướt sóng)
wonder	noun	/'wʌn.dər/	A feeling of surprise mixed with admiration, caused by something beautiful, unexpected, or inexplicable.	Sự kỳ diệu, cảm giác kinh ngạc

Describe a place where you saw many animals.

You should say:

- **When you went there**
- **Who you went with**
- **What animals you saw there**
- **And explain how you felt about the place**

Version 1

“Okay, so a really memorable place I visited with my family was Vinpearl Safari in Phu Quoc. We went there last summer. It's a huge, modern wildlife park, and honestly, it's completely different from the old-style zoos I went to as a kid. We wanted to do something that would be both fun and educational for our two children.

The most impressive part for me was the safari tour. You get on this special bus, and it drives you through a huge open area where the animals are the ones roaming free. Seeing amazing animals like rhinos and giraffes walking right next to our bus was just breathtaking. The highlight was definitely when we got to feed the giraffes. My kids were so excited, and I have to say, I was just as amazed as they were.

Besides the safari, the park had lots of other animals in large, clean enclosures. One thing I really liked was that they focused a lot on conservation. There was information everywhere about the animals and the problems they face in the wild.

My feeling about the trip was a little mixed, to be honest. On one hand, it was wonderful to see these animals in such a great environment. But on the other hand, it's a little sad, you know, because it reminds you they're still in captivity. But overall, it was a fantastic experience. It sparked a lot of curiosity in my children and definitely gave our whole family a deeper appreciation for wildlife.”

Version 2

“Okay, so I’d like to talk about a recent visit to the Saigon Zoo and Botanical Gardens. It's really close to the city center, and it's a place most people in Saigon have been to. A few months ago, me and my friends went there, kind of on a whim. We were just looking for something different to do on a Sunday that wasn't too expensive.

The first thing you notice is how old the place is; the trees are huge and ancient, which makes it really beautiful and shady. But seeing the animals... honestly, I had mixed feelings. On the one hand, it brought back good memories from when I was a kid and my parents took me there. But on the other hand, now that I'm older, I couldn't help but notice that some of the cages looked a bit old and small, especially for the big animals like tigers and elephants.

We spent a while just watching the monkeys. It was actually really fascinating to see how they all interacted with each other.

But the most interesting part was that the visit sparked a big conversation between us afterwards. We started talking about the role of modern zoos, you know, whether it's right to keep animals like that. So, while it was a nice afternoon, it also left me with a lot to think about regarding animal welfare. It was definitely more thought-provoking than I expected.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
animal welfare	noun phrase	/'æn.i.məl 'wel.feər/	The health, happiness, and good condition of animals.	Phúc lợi động vật
appreciation	noun	/ə, pri: .ʃi'ei.ʃən/	A feeling of being grateful for something; understanding of the good qualities of something.	Sự trân trọng, đánh giá cao
brehtaking	adjective	/'breθ, tei.kɪ/	Extremely beautiful, exciting, or surprising.	Ngoạn mục, hấp dẫn đến nghệt thở
captivity	noun	/kæp'tɪv.ə.ti/	The situation in which a person or animal is kept in a prison or a small, enclosed space.	Tình trạng bị nuôi nhốt
conservation	noun	/'kɒn.sə'veɪ.ʃən/	The protection of animals, plants, and natural resources.	Sự bảo tồn
educational	adjective	/'edʒ.ʊ'keɪ.ʃən.əl/	Providing education, or relating to education.	Mang tính giáo dục
enclosure	noun	/ɪn'kləʊ.ʒər/	An area of land surrounded by a fence or wall, especially for keeping animals in.	Khu vực rào lại (chuồng thú)
fascinating	adjective	/'fæs.ən.eɪ.tɪ/	Extremely interesting and attractive.	Hấp dẫn, lôi cuốn
highlight	noun	/'haɪ.laɪt/	The best or most exciting or memorable part of something.	Điểm nhấn, phần nổi bật nhất
impressive	adjective	/ɪm'pres.ɪv/	Causing a feeling of admiration and respect	Gây ấn tượng,

			because of its size, quality, or skill.	đáng ngưỡng mộ
interact	verb	/,ɪn.tər'ækt/	To communicate with or react to each other.	Tương tác
mixed feelings	idiom	/mɪkst 'fiː.lɪŋz/	A combination of positive and negative emotions about something.	Cảm xúc lẫn lộn
on a whim	idiom	/ɒn ə wɪm/	Based on a sudden, unplanned decision.	Một cách ngẫu hứng, đột ngột
roaming	verb	/'rəʊ.mɪŋ/	To move about or travel, especially over a wide area, with no clear purpose.	Đi lang thang, đi lại tự do
spark (v)	verb	/spɑːk/	To cause something to start or develop, especially an argument or excitement.	Gây ra, khơi mào, châm ngòi
thought-provoking	adjective	/'θɔːt.prə,vəʊ.kɪŋ/	Making you think a lot about a subject.	Gợi nhiều suy nghĩ, đáng suy ngẫm

Describe an advertisement you have seen that introduced a well-known product

You should say:

- When and where you saw the advertisement
- What the product was
- How you liked the advertisement
- And explain how you felt about it

Version 1

“Okay, so an advertisement that I think almost everyone in Vietnam knows is the 'Vườn Cao Việt Nam' campaign by Vinamilk. You know, Vinamilk is the biggest dairy company in our country. I've seen this ad many times over the years, mostly on TV and on platforms like YouTube, especially during big holidays like the Tết holiday.

What's so clever about this ad is that it's not really about the milk itself. Instead, it shows these beautiful, cinematic shots of children from all over Vietnam, from the northern mountains to the southern Mekong Delta. And they're all singing this incredibly powerful and hopeful song. The ad is filled with these amazing drone shots of Vietnam's landscapes which are just breathtaking.

So really, the ad isn't selling a product; it's selling a feeling. It's all about national pride, hope for the future, and unity. Honestly, every time I see it, it really tugs at the heartstrings. It just makes you feel proud to be Vietnamese.

And I think that's why it's so effective. By connecting their brand with these really strong, positive feelings, Vinamilk does more than just sell milk; they make people incredibly loyal to their brand. It makes you see them as more than just a company, but as a part of the country's story and its future. It's a very smart and genuinely moving advertisement.”

Version 2

“Okay, so an ad that was literally everywhere recently was for the e-wallet Momo, especially during their 'Lắc Xì' campaign for the Tết holiday. Honestly, you couldn't escape it. I saw it all over my social media feeds – you know, on Facebook, TikTok, and as one of those ads you have to watch before a YouTube video.

The ad itself was super energetic and fun. It featured a bunch of famous Vietnamese singers and comedians, and they had this really catchy jingle. The whole point of the ad was to get people to open the Momo app and physically shake their phone. And when you did that, you could win random amounts of lucky money – 'lì xì' – or different discount vouchers.

I thought the whole campaign was genius. It was so clever because it tapped right into our cultural tradition of giving lucky money during the Lunar New Year. And because it was interactive, it didn't feel like a normal ad you just sit and watch; it felt more like a national game. It created a huge buzz.

I mean, all my friends were talking about it, and we were all comparing who got the best prizes. So it was a super effective way to get tons of people, especially younger people, to use their app multiple times every day. It was fun, relevant, and yeah, I have to admit, I was shaking my phone constantly during that time!”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
campaign	noun	/kæm'peɪn/	A planned group of activities that are intended to achieve a particular aim.	Chiến dịch
catchy	adjective	/'kætʃ.i/	(of a tune or phrase) pleasant and easy to remember.	Bắt tai, dễ nhớ
cinematic	adjective	/,sɪ.nə'mæt.ɪk/	Having the qualities of a motion picture.	Như phim điện ảnh, có chất lượng điện ảnh
constantly	adverb	/'kɒn.stənt.li/	All the time or often.	Liên tục, không ngừng
cultural tradition	noun phrase	/'kʌl.tʃər.əl trə'dɪʃ.ən/	A belief or behavior passed down within a group or society with symbolic meaning.	Truyền thống văn hóa
effective	adjective	/ɪ'fek.tɪv/	Successful in producing a desired or intended result.	Hiệu quả
energetic	adjective	/,en.ə'dʒet.ɪk/	Showing or involving great activity or vitality.	Tràn đầy năng lượng, sôi nổi
feature (v)	verb	/'fi:tʃər/	To have as a prominent attribute or aspect; to star or include.	Có sự tham gia của, bao gồm
genuinely	adverb	/'dʒen.ju.m.li/	Truly; in a way that is real and not false.	Thật sự, chân thật
interactive	adjective	/,ɪn.tər'æk.tɪv/	Allowing a two-way flow of information between a device and a user.	Có tính tương tác
loyal	adjective	/'ləɪ.əl/	Giving or showing firm and constant support to	Trung thành

			a person, brand, or institution.	
moving	adjective	/ˈmuː.vɪŋ/	Producing strong emotions, especially of sadness or sympathy.	Cảm động, lay động lòng người
national pride	noun phrase	/ˌnæʃ.ən.əl praɪd/	A feeling of patriotism and pride in one's country.	Niềm tự hào dân tộc
tap into	phrasal verb	/tæp ˈm.tuː/	To manage to use something in a way that brings good results.	Khai thác, tận dụng
tugs at the heartstrings	idiom	/tʌgz æt ðə ˈhɑːt.strɪŋz/	To cause strong feelings of sympathy or sadness.	Làm lay động lòng người
unity	noun	/ˈjuː.nə.ti/	The state of being joined together or in agreement.	Sự đoàn kết, sự thống nhất

THE
FORUM

Describe a time when a person persuaded you to do something and you were happy about that

You should say:

- **Who the person was**
- **When and where it happened**
- **What he/she persuaded you to do**
- **And explain why you were happy about it**

Version 1

“Okay, a time that really stands out for me was about two years ago, when a senior colleague persuaded me to take on a project I was really nervous about.

At the time, I was working as a brand manager, and my company wanted to launch a big new digital marketing strategy. They offered me the role of project leader, but honestly, my background was mostly in traditional marketing, so this was completely out of my comfort zone. I was all ready to say no.

My colleague's name is Minh, and he's someone I really respect. He asked me to grab a coffee, and I was prepared to list all my excuses – you know, being too busy, not having the right experience. But he was very smart about it. He didn't pressure me. Instead, he explained the vision for the project and emphasized that they were looking for a leader, not necessarily a technical expert. He framed it as a huge opportunity for me to develop skills that were becoming super important in our field.

But the thing that really convinced me was his confidence in me. He said he saw my potential to lead and promised to support me all the way. That was enough for me to say yes. It was definitely a steep learning curve, no doubt, but the project ended up being a huge success. And that experience really paid off; it was the main reason I got promoted to Marketing Director a year later. So yeah, I'm incredibly glad he persuaded me, because it honestly changed my career for the better.”

Version 2

“Okay, a time that really stands out was back in my freshman year of university. It was my close friend, Lan, who persuaded me to do something I was absolutely terrified of, which was to join the university's English Debating Club.

At that time, I was really insecure about my spoken English. The thought of speaking in public, in front of other students, just gave me so much anxiety. So naturally, my first reaction was a hard 'no'.

But Lan was very patient. She didn't just say, 'You have to do it!'. She was actually really smart about how she persuaded me. She started by saying she understood my fears, but she explained that the club was a safe place to practice and improve, not a stage for perfect speakers. She mentioned that almost everyone started out feeling nervous. But the final push was her offer to sign up with me, so I wouldn't have to do it alone.

Her support and logical reasons made me decide to take the leap. And honestly, it turned out to be a total game-changer for me. My confidence grew so much, my English improved a lot faster than I expected, and I made a bunch of new friends. Looking back, I'm so happy she took the time to convince me, because otherwise, I would have missed out on one of my best university experiences.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
anxiety	noun	/æŋ'zai.ə.ti/	A feeling of worry, nervousness, or unease about something with an uncertain outcome.	Sự lo lắng, bất an
background	noun	/'bæk.graʊnd/	The type of family, education, and experience someone has.	Nền tảng, kinh nghiệm
confidence	noun	/'kɒn.fi.dəns/	The feeling or belief that one can have faith in or rely on someone or something.	Sự tự tin
convince	verb	/kən'vɪns/	To cause someone to believe firmly in the truth of something; to persuade.	Thuyết phục (làm cho tin)
emphasize	verb	/'em.fə.saɪz/	To give special importance or prominence to something in speaking or writing.	Nhấn mạnh
frame something as	phrasal verb	/freɪm 'sʌm.θɪŋ əz/	To express something in a particular way.	Diễn đạt, mô tả điều gì như là
insecure	adjective	/,ɪn.sɪ'kjʊər/	Not confident or assured; uncertain and anxious.	Tự ti, không an toàn
launch	verb	/lə:ntʃ/	To start or set in motion an activity or enterprise.	Khởi động, ra mắt
miss out on	phrasal verb	/mɪs aʊt ɒn/	To fail to use an opportunity to experience or enjoy something.	Bỏ lỡ
paid off	phrasal verb	/peɪd ɒf/	(of a course of action) to bring good results; succeed.	Được đền đáp, mang lại kết quả tốt

persuade	verb	/pə'sweɪd/	To cause someone to do something through reasoning or argument.	Thuyết phục (để làm gì đó)
potential	noun	/pə'ten.ʃəl/	Latent qualities or abilities that may be developed and lead to future success.	Tiềm năng
promote	verb	/prə'məʊt/	To raise someone to a higher or more important position or rank.	Thăng chức
stands out	phrasal verb	/stændz aʊt/	To be very noticeable or impressive.	Nổi bật
take the leap	idiom	/teɪk ðə li:p/	To commit to a course of action, especially one that is seen as risky.	Quyết định mạo hiểm, làm một bước đột phá
vision	noun	/'vɪʒ.ən/	The ability to think about or plan the future with imagination or wisdom.	Tầm nhìn

Describe a website that sells second-hand items

You should say:

- **What the website is**
- **How you found out about it**
- **What people can buy from it**
- **And explain whether you like it or not**

Version 1

“Okay, so I'm going to talk about a website that I'm sure pretty much everyone in Vietnam knows. It's called Chợ Tốt, which basically translates to 'Good Market'. You see their ads everywhere, so it's hard to miss. I started using it a couple of years ago when I was setting up my home office and needed some furniture, but didn't want to spend a fortune.

It's essentially a huge online marketplace for people to buy and sell used things. You can find almost anything on there – from big-ticket items like motorbikes and apartments to smaller stuff like electronics, clothes, or even pets. At that time, I was looking for a solid bookshelf. I found a great one made of real wood on Chợ Tốt for a fraction of the price of a new one.

So, the way it works is you browse the listings, and if you find something you like, you contact the seller directly, either through the app's chat or by calling them. This is where you have to be a bit careful. For my bookshelf, I had to check the seller's rating and ask a lot of questions to make sure it was legitimate. In the end, I met up with the seller, checked the bookshelf to see if it was in good condition, and then I bought it.

And do I like it? Yes, I definitely do. I mean, it can feel like a bit of a gamble since there's no official warranty, but I really like that you can negotiate the price. Plus, it's a great way to find unique items and it promotes a more sustainable lifestyle by giving old things a new home. For me, it's a super useful tool if you're looking to save some money.”

Version 2

“Okay, so for buying second-hand things, I don't really use a formal website. Instead, I mainly use a dedicated Facebook group. It's called something like 'Hội Sinh Viên Pass Đồ Sài Gòn', which basically means 'Saigon Students' Item-Passing Group'. 'Pass đồ' is a common slang term we use for selling or giving away things you don't use anymore. A friend of mine added me to the group back in my first year of university when I was moving into a dorm and needed to get a lot of stuff on a tight budget.

The group is basically a huge online market just for students. You can find literally anything a student would need – old textbooks, clothes, kitchen stuff, and small furniture. I remember needing a mini-fridge for my room, and buying a new one was just out of the question for me financially. So I posted a 'looking for' message in the group, and within an hour, I had a few different offers. I ended up buying a perfectly good one from a senior who was graduating, for about a third of the retail price.

What I love about it is the sense of community. You're buying from other students, so there's a feeling of trust, and you can always haggle a little bit, which is nice. It's honestly a lifesaver for students. The only downside is that it can be a bit chaotic. There's no system, so you just have to scroll through the feed, and good items get snapped up in minutes. But overall, for students trying to save money and reduce waste, it's an essential group to be in.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
big-ticket item	noun phrase	/ˌbɪɡ.tɪk.ɪt 'aɪ.təm/	An item that is very expensive, such as a car or a house.	Món hàng đắt tiền
browse	verb	/braʊz/	To look through a book or a collection of things without a specific goal.	Lướt xem, xem qua
chaotic	adjective	/keɪ'ɒt.ɪk/	In a state of complete confusion and disorder.	Hỗn loạn, lộn xộn
dedicated	adjective	/'ded.ɪ.keɪ.tɪd/	Exclusively designed or assigned to one purpose or person.	Chuyên dụng, dành riêng
downside	noun	/'daʊn.saɪd/	The disadvantage of a situation.	Nhược điểm, mặt trái
essential	adjective	/'es.ɪ.ʃəl/	Absolutely necessary; extremely important.	Thiết yếu, cần thiết
fraction of the price	idiom	/'fræk.ʃən əv ðə praɪs/	A very small part of the original cost.	Một phần nhỏ của giá gốc
haggle	verb	/'hæɡ.əl/	To dispute or bargain persistently, especially over the cost of something.	Mặc cả, trả giá
legitimate	adjective	/lə'dʒɪt.ə.mət/	Conforming to the law or to rules; able to be trusted.	Hợp pháp, đáng tin cậy
lifesaver	noun	/'laɪf,seɪ.vər/	A thing that saves one from a difficult situation.	Vị cứu tinh
negotiate	verb	/nə'ɡəʊ.ʃi.ət/	To have a formal discussion to reach an agreement.	Đàm phán, thương lượng
out of the question	idiom	/aʊt əv ðə 'kwes.tʃən/	Not possible or not allowed.	Không thể được, không thể nào
promote	verb	/prə'məʊt/	To support or actively encourage something.	Thúc đẩy, quảng bá

snapped up	phrasal verb	/snæpt ʌp/	To buy or get something quickly and enthusiastically because it is cheap or exactly what you want.	Được mua hết rất nhanh
sustainable	adjective	/sə'steɪ.nə.bəl/	Causing little or no damage to the environment and therefore able to continue for a long time.	Bền vững
tight budget	noun phrase	/taɪt 'bʌdʒ.ɪt/	A small amount of money available to spend.	Ngân sách eo hẹp

THE
FORUM

Describe a time when you and some other people made a plan to do an activity
You should say:

- **What the plan was**
- **When and where you made the plan**
- **What the activity was**
- **And explain how you felt about the plan**

Version 1

“Okay, so a time that comes to mind was about a few months ago, when my colleagues and I planned a surprise farewell party for our boss. He was retiring after working with the company for 20 years, so it was a pretty big deal, and we wanted to do something special for him.

We had to plan everything in secret, of course. We made a private Zalo group, without our boss in it, and did most of the brainstorming there. We'd also have these quick, quiet meetings in the office kitchen to figure out the details. The main plan was to book a private room at a nice restaurant, secretly invite his wife, and create a memory book filled with photos and nice messages from everyone. My job was basically to handle the budget and collect money from everyone for a group gift.

So, the activity was the party itself. We had to coordinate everything really carefully. We had to make sure everyone got to the restaurant on time, and we also had to trick our boss into going there, telling him it was a client dinner or something. There were a lot of moving parts, and honestly, I was a bit worried about whether we could pull it off.

But in the end, it was a huge success. The look on his face when he walked in and everyone yelled 'Surprise!' was just amazing. He was so shocked and happy, and that made all the stressful planning totally worth it. For me, it was more than just a party. The process of planning it all together really brought our team closer. It was a great feeling and it showed what our team could do when we all worked towards the same goal.”

Version 2

“I can tell you about a plan my team and I made last semester for a big group presentation in our marketing class. You know how group projects can sometimes be a real nightmare if they're not organised, so we knew we had to have a solid plan from the very beginning.

The project itself was about creating a marketing strategy for a new coffee brand. The day after we got the assignment, the four of us met up at a cafe near campus to figure everything out. The first, and I think most important, part of our plan was to divide the work based on our strengths. So, one person took care of the market research, another handled the budget and numbers, my job was to design the presentation slides, and the fourth member was our main speaker.

To keep everything in one place, we created a shared Google Drive folder. We also set up a detailed timeline with clear deadlines for each task, which was super helpful. We agreed to have a quick meeting every week just to check in, make sure we were all on the same page, and that everyone was doing their part.

Honestly, I felt really good about this plan. It made a huge project feel manageable and much less stressful. It's pretty common in university for one or two people to end up doing all the work in a group. But because our plan was so clear and fair from the start, everyone contributed equally. This created a really great team spirit, and in the end, we got one of the highest grades in the class. The planning was definitely the key to our success.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
brainstorming	noun	/ˈbreɪn.stɔːm.ɪŋ/	The process of generating creative ideas and solutions through group discussion.	Động não, thảo luận ý tưởng
colleague	noun	/ˈkɒl.iːg/	A person with whom one works in a profession or business.	Đồng nghiệp
contribute	verb	/kənˈtrib.juːt/	To give something, especially money or effort, in order to help achieve or provide something.	Đóng góp
coordinate	verb	/kəʊˈɔː.dɪ.nert/	To organize the different parts of an activity and the people involved so that it works well.	Phối hợp, điều phối
deadline	noun	/ˈded.laɪn/	A time or day by which something must be done.	Hạn chót
divide	verb	/dɪˈvaɪd/	To separate or be separated into parts.	Phân chia
farewell	noun	/ˌfeəˈwel/	An occasion when someone says goodbye.	Sự chia tay, tiễn biệt
manageable	adjective	/ˈmæn.ɪ.dʒə.bəl/	Able to be dealt with or controlled easily.	Có thể quản lý, kiểm soát được
moving parts	noun phrase	/ˈmuː.vɪŋ pɑːts/	The different elements or components of a complex situation that must be managed.	Các yếu tố/phần việc cần phối hợp

nightmare	noun	/'naɪt.meə/	An experience that is very frightening or unpleasant.	Cơn ác mộng
on the same page	idiom	/ɒn ðə seɪm peɪdʒ/	To have the same understanding or way of thinking about something.	Chung suy nghĩ, cùng quan điểm
pull it off	phrasal verb	/pʊl ɪt ɒf/	To succeed in doing something difficult or unexpected.	Thực hiện thành công (việc khó)
retire	verb	/rɪ'taɪər/	To leave your job and stop working, usually because of old age.	Về hưu
solid	adjective	/'sɒl.ɪd/	Certain or safe; of a good standard; giving confidence or support.	Vững chắc, đáng tin cậy
strategy	noun	/'stræt.ə.dʒi/	A detailed plan for achieving success in situations such as business, politics, or war.	Chiến lược
team spirit	noun phrase	/tiːm 'spɪr.ɪt/	The feeling of friendship and loyalty that exists between the members of a team.	Tinh thần đồng đội

Describe a person from a different cultural background with whom you enjoy spending time.

You should say:

- **Who he/she is**
- **Where he/she is from**
- **Where/how you knew him/her**
- **And explain how you feel about him/her**

Version 1

"I'd like to talk about a good friend of mine from work; his name is John. He's from Sydney, Australia, and we've gotten to know each other really well over the last year. He's a project manager in the IT department at my company here in Ho Chi Minh City.

We actually met through work. His team was leading a big software project, and my department was one of the main users, so we had to have a lot of meetings. At first, all our conversations were very professional, you know, just about work. But we really broke the ice at a company dinner. We started talking and discovered that we both love craft beer, and that was pretty much the start of our friendship.

Now, we have a bit of a routine where we often grab dinner or a drink after a long week. I've made it my personal mission to introduce him to real Vietnamese street food – the kind of hidden gems that you won't find in a travel guide. In return, he's a great cook and he hosted a fantastic Australian-style barbecue for a few of us from the office at his apartment.

I genuinely enjoy my time with him because he offers a really refreshing perspective on life. We have these fascinating chats comparing work culture in Australia versus Vietnam, especially things like work-life balance. He's incredibly open-minded and has a great, dry sense of humour that I really appreciate. Spending time with him has definitely helped me broaden my horizons and see my own culture from a different point of view."

Version 2

“Sure, a person that comes to mind right away is my friend, Amélie. She’s from France, and she was an exchange student at my university for a semester last year.

We actually met through a university program called the 'Language Buddy' program. The idea was to pair a local student with an exchange student to help each other with languages. I was studying French, and she wanted to improve her Vietnamese. The plan was to meet for an hour a week, but we just hit it off immediately, and our meetings quickly became more about just hanging out.

We ended up spending a ton of time together. I kind of became her unofficial tour guide, taking her to all my favourite street food places in Saigon that she wouldn't find on her own. And in return, she introduced me to French culture. I have a great memory of her teaching me how to make proper crêpes in her tiny dorm room kitchen. We did everything together, from exploring the city to cramming for our exams in the library.

I just loved my time with Amélie because she was so curious and had such an open mind. Being with her helped me see my own city through fresh eyes; things I took for granted every day, she found fascinating. Her attitude towards life was also a really refreshing change from the intense academic pressure we all feel. It was a true cultural exchange, and I feel like my own perspective really widened just from being her friend.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
academic pressure	noun phrase	/,æk.ə'dem.ɪk 'pref.ər/	The stress and demands related to schoolwork and achieving good grades.	Áp lực học tập
appreciate	verb	/ə'priː.ʃi.ət/	To recognize the full worth of; to be grateful for something.	Trân trọng, công nhận giá trị
break the ice	idiom	/breɪk ði aɪs/	To say or do something to make people feel more relaxed and comfortable when they first meet.	Phá vỡ bầu không khí ngại ngùng
broaden horizons	idiom	/'brɔː.dən hə'raɪ.zənz/	To increase the range of one's knowledge, understanding, or experience.	Mở rộng tầm hiểu biết
cram	verb	/kræm/	To study intensively over a short period of time just before an examination.	Học nhồi nhét
cultural exchange	noun phrase	/'kʌl.tʃər.əl ɪks'tʃeɪndʒ/	The process of sharing ideas, customs, and social behaviors between different cultures.	Trao đổi văn hóa
exchange student	noun phrase	/ɪks'tʃeɪndʒ 'stjuː.dənt/	A student from one country who studies for a period of time at a school or university in another country.	Sinh viên trao đổi
fascinating	adjective	/'fæs.ən.eɪ.tɪŋ/	Extremely interesting.	Hấp dẫn, lôi cuốn
genuinely	adverb	/'dʒen.ju.m.li/	Truly; in a way that is real and not false.	Thật sự, chân thật

hidden gem	noun phrase	/ˌhɪd.ən ˈdʒem/	Something or someone of outstanding quality that is not well-known.	“Viên ngọc ẩn”, nơi hay ho ít người biết
hit it off	idiom	/hɪt ɪt ɒf/	To like someone and become friendly immediately.	Hợp nhau ngay lập tức
host (v)	verb	/həʊst/	To provide the space and food for a special event.	Đăng cai, chủ trì (bữa tiệc)
in return	phrase	/ɪn rɪˈtʃːn/	As a response or reaction to something.	Đổi lại, đáp lại
open-minded	adjective	/ˌəʊ.pənˈmaɪn.dɪd/	Willing to consider new ideas; unprejudiced.	Cởi mở, phóng khoáng
perspective	noun	/pəˈspek.tɪv/	A particular way of considering something.	Góc nhìn, quan điểm
take for granted	idiom	/teɪk fɔːr ˈgrɑːn.tɪd/	To not show that you are grateful for someone or something, and forget that you are lucky to have them.	Coi là điều hiển nhiên

Describe a city that you have been to and would like to visit again

You should say:

- **When you visited it**
- **What you did there**
- **What it was like**
- **And explain why you would like to visit it again**

Version 1

“A city that I’d love to visit again is definitely Da Lat. It’s a beautiful city up in the Central Highlands of Vietnam. For anyone living in a big, busy city like Ho Chi Minh City, it’s the perfect place for a weekend escape. I went there most recently last year with my husband on a short holiday, just to get away from the heat and the stress of work.

On this particular trip, we tried to do things a bit differently. Instead of visiting all the famous tourist spots, we rented a motorbike and just explored the small roads in the countryside. We spent our days visiting little coffee plantations, enjoying the cool, fresh air, and finding quiet spots to read. And of course, the food was a huge part of the trip. We spent every evening at the night market, just enjoying all the local street food, like grilled rice paper, which we call Vietnamese pizza, and drinking hot soy milk to stay warm.

The main reason I’m so keen to go back is just the atmosphere. It’s so peaceful and relaxed there. It’s a real break from my usual hectic schedule, and it’s the one place where I feel I can properly disconnect and recharge my batteries. I feel like there are still so many hidden gems to discover there - you know, more quiet cafes or beautiful hiking trails. It’s a city that really invites you to slow down, and I always leave feeling completely refreshed.”

Version 2

“One city I'd absolutely love to go back to is the ancient town of Hoi An. It's that famous UNESCO World Heritage site in central Vietnam. I went there last summer with some of my best friends from university. It's a super popular place for young people to visit, and I can totally see why.

We spent three days there, and honestly, it felt like stepping back in time. We spent most of our time just wandering through the beautiful little alleyways, you know, admiring all the old yellow houses with the colourful flowers everywhere. We also rented bicycles and cycled to An Bang beach nearby, which was really relaxing. But the highlight for everyone was definitely the evening. The whole town is lit up by thousands of colourful lanterns, and it's just a magical sight. We bought some paper lanterns, made a wish, and released them on the Hoai River, which was a really special moment.

I really want to return because Hoi An has this unique, timeless atmosphere. Every corner looks like a painting. However, the only thing was, we went during the peak tourist season, and it was incredibly crowded. Some parts almost felt like a tourist trap. I'd love to go back during a quieter time of year, maybe in the off-season, to really soak in the peaceful atmosphere properly and maybe explore the local craft villages without so many people around.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
ancient	adjective	/ˈem.ʃənt/	Belonging to the very distant past and no longer in existence.	Cổ xưa, cổ kính
atmosphere	noun	/ˈæt.mə.sfiər/	The mood or feeling of a place or situation.	Bầu không khí
disconnect	verb	/ˌdɪs.kəˈnekt/	To take a break from the stress of daily life, especially from work and technology.	Ngắt kết nối, tạm gác lại (công việc)
hectic	adjective	/ˈhek.tɪk/	Full of incessant or frantic activity.	Bận rộn, hối hả, tất bật
hidden gem	noun phrase	/ˌhɪd.ən ˈdʒem/	Something or someone of outstanding quality that is not well-known.	“Viên ngọc ẩn”, nơi hay ho ít người biết
keen to do sth	idiom	/ki:n tə du:/	To be very interested or enthusiastic about doing something.	Háo hức, rất muốn làm gì đó
off-season	noun	/ˈɒf.siː.zən/	The time of year when a place has fewer tourists, and prices are often lower.	Mùa du lịch thấp điểm
peak season	noun	/pi:k ˈsiː.zən/	The time of year when a place has the most tourists.	Mùa du lịch cao điểm
plantation	noun	/plænˈteɪ.ʃən/	A large farm, especially in a hot country, where crops such as coffee, tea, or sugar are grown.	Đồn điền
recharge one's batteries	idiom	/riːtʃɑːdʒ wʌnz ˈbæt.ər.ɪz/	To rest and relax in order to get back your energy.	Nạp lại năng lượng

refreshed	adjective	/rɪ'freʃt/	Feeling less tired and having more energy.	Sảng khoái, tươi mới trở lại
soak in	phrasal verb	/səʊk ɪn/	To spend time experiencing and enjoying a place or an atmosphere.	Đắm mình trong, tận hưởng
timeless	adjective	/'taɪm.ləs/	Not affected by the passage of time or changes in fashion.	Vượt thời gian, không bao giờ lỗi mốt
tourist trap	noun phrase	/'tʊə.rɪst træp/	A place that attracts many tourists and charges them high prices.	Nơi bẫy khách du lịch
unique	adjective	/ju:'ni:k/	Being the only one of its kind; unlike anything else.	Độc đáo, độc nhất
wander	verb	/'wɒn.dər/	To walk around slowly in a relaxed way or without any clear purpose or direction.	Đi lang thang

THE
FORUM

Describe a shop/store you enjoy visiting.

You should say:

- **What the shop's name is**
- **Where it is**
- **How often you visit it**
- **And explain why you like to visit it**

Version 1

“Okay, a place I genuinely enjoy visiting is the Phương Nam Bookstore, specifically the big one on Nguyen Oanh street. My job as a financial analyst is pretty hectic, so this bookstore has become my little sanctuary – a place where I can go to relax and switch off.

On the surface, it's just a regular bookstore. It sells a huge range of books, nice stationery, and some small gifts. But for me, it's much more than that. It's a quiet, cool, and really well-organized space where I can completely disconnect from the digital world. I usually go alone on a Sunday morning; it's my dedicated 'me time'. I can easily spend an hour or two just wandering through the aisles, not really looking for anything specific.

What I love most is the simple pleasure of picking up a physical book, feeling the paper, and reading the first couple of pages. It's an experience that online shopping just can't replicate. Sometimes I'll leave with a stack of new books, other times I'll leave with nothing. It doesn't really matter.

The main reason I love it is because the whole atmosphere is incredibly therapeutic. Just getting lost among the bookshelves, surrounded by the quiet hum of other readers and the smell of new books... it just makes me feel so much calmer and more centered. It's a simple but really important part of my routine.”

Version 2

“A store I absolutely love visiting is L'Usine. It's a pretty well-known concept store in Ho Chi Minh City, with a few locations in the main districts. It's the kind of place my friends and I go to when we want to treat ourselves or just hang out in a really nice environment.

What's cool about L'Usine is that it's a mix of a café and a shop. So, downstairs, there's usually a bustling café with amazing coffee and brunch food. Then, when you go upstairs, you'll find a retail space. They sell clothes from local Vietnamese designers, unique books, and really beautifully designed homeware and stationery. It all has a very stylish, kind of international vibe. It just feels a bit more special than the regular chain stores you find in a mall.

I enjoy visiting because it's a space where you can do a couple of things at once. I can kill two birds with one stone: go for a delicious coffee and then browse around for a unique birthday present for a friend. The whole place is designed so well, which makes it a really pleasant place to just be.

I usually go with friends on a weekend afternoon. We'll have a long chat over coffee and then just explore the shop. It's less about needing to buy something and more about enjoying the creative atmosphere and just being in a cool, inspiring space.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
aisle	noun	/aɪl/	A long, narrow space between rows of shelves in a store.	Lối đi (giữa các kệ hàng)
bustling	adjective	/'bʌs.lɪŋ/	Full of busy activity; very energetic and noisy.	Nhộn nhịp, hối hả
chain store	noun phrase	/tʃeɪn stɔːr/	One of a series of stores owned by the same company and selling the same merchandise.	Chuỗi cửa hàng
concept store	noun phrase	/'kɒn.sept stɔːr/	A shop that sells a carefully curated selection of products that connect to a particular theme.	Cửa hàng ý tưởng
dedicated	adjective	/'ded.ɪ.keɪ.tɪd/	Used for one particular purpose.	Dành riêng cho
disconnect	verb	/,dɪs.kə'nekt/	To take a break from the stress of daily life, especially from work and technology.	Ngắt kết nối, tạm gác lại
genuinely	adverb	/'dʒen.ju.m.li/	Truly; in a way that is real and not false.	Thật sự, chân thật
hectic	adjective	/'hek.tɪk/	Full of incessant or frantic activity.	Bận rộn, hối hả, tất bật
inspiring	adjective	/ɪn'spaɪə.rɪŋ/	Making you feel hopeful or encouraged.	Truyền cảm hứng
kill two birds with one stone	idiom	/kɪl tuː bɜːdz wɪð wʌn stəʊn/	To succeed in achieving two things in a single action.	Một mũi tên trúng hai đích
replicate	verb	/'rep.lɪ.keɪt/	To make or do something again in exactly the same way.	Tái tạo, sao chép
sanctuary	noun	/'sæŋk.tʃu.ə.ri/	A peaceful place that provides protection or a safe place to rest.	Nơi trú ẩn, nơi tôn nghiêm

stationery	noun	/'steɪ.ʃən.ər.i/	Materials for writing and for use in an office, like paper, pens, and envelopes.	Văn phòng phẩm
stylish	adjective	/'staɪ.lɪʃ/	Fashionable and attractive.	Phong cách, sành điệu
therapeutic	adjective	/,θer.ə'pi:ʊ.tɪk/	Making you feel happier and more relaxed.	Có tác dụng trị liệu, thư giãn
treat yourself	phrase	/tri:t jɔ:'self/	To do or buy something special for yourself that you will enjoy.	Tự thưởng cho bản thân

THE
FORUM

Describe a person you disliked at first but ended up being friends with
You should say:

- **Who he/she is**
- **How you knew him/her**
- **Why you disliked him/her at first**
- **And explain how you became friends**

Version 1

“That's an interesting question. The person that comes to mind right away is my current manager, Khoa. He joined my department about a year ago, and honestly, my first impression of him wasn't good at all.

In our first few meetings, he just came across as a know-it-all. He was very direct and was always challenging our team's existing ideas. I completely mistook his confidence for arrogance and thought he was going to be really difficult to work with.

But my opinion of him totally changed when we were both assigned to work on a really important and urgent project together. We had to work very closely, often late into the night. It was during those high-pressure situations that I got to see his true character. I realized his directness wasn't arrogance; he was just really passionate about doing excellent work and refused to settle for 'good enough'. He was also incredibly smart and surprisingly supportive.

We started to bond over the shared stress, often making jokes to get through the tough days. I started to let my guard down, and we discovered we actually had a lot in common outside of work. The project, which I was initially dreading, turned out to be a blessing in disguise. We're now good work friends; we often have lunch together and bounce ideas off each other. It was a classic lesson for me in not judging a book by its cover.”

Version 2

“This is a pretty classic university story, actually. Last year, in my statistics course, I was put in a group for a major project with a guy named Tuan. And after our first meeting, I really disliked him. He was completely silent, seemed totally uninterested, and didn't contribute a single idea. I immediately jumped to the conclusion that he was a 'free-rider' – you know, the kind of person who was going to do no work. I was pretty worried about my grade.

A few days later, feeling frustrated, I decided to just talk to him privately after class. I was kind of expecting an argument, but instead, he just looked completely exhausted. He opened up to me and explained that he was studying for a double major and was just completely swamped with assignments. He wasn't lazy; he was just burnt out.

That conversation changed everything. We decided to change our plan and play to his strengths. It turned out he was amazing at the data analysis part, just not great at brainstorming. So, we gave him all the data work, he did an incredible job, and our project turned out great.

That whole experience was a real blessing in disguise. We realized we had a lot in common and started studying together after that. Now, he's one of my closest friends on campus.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
arrogance	noun	/ˈær.ə.ɡəns/	The quality of being unpleasantly proud and behaving as if you are more important than other people.	Sự kiêu ngạo, ngạo mạn
a blessing in disguise	idiom	/ə ˌbles.ɪŋ ɪn dɪsˈgaɪz/	Something that seems bad at first, but results in something good happening later.	Trong cái rủi có cái may
bond (v)	verb	/bɒnd/	To develop a close connection or strong relationship with someone.	Gắn kết
bounce ideas off sb	idiom	/baʊns aɪˈdɪəz ɒf/	To share your ideas with someone to get their opinion.	Trao đổi, tham khảo ý tưởng với ai đó
burnt out	adjective	/ˌbɜːnt ˈaʊt/	Feeling ill or tired because you have been working too hard.	Kiệt sức, “cháy sạch” năng lượng
come across as	phrasal verb	/kʌm əˈkrɒs æz/	To behave in a way that makes people believe you have a particular characteristic.	Gây ấn tượng là, có vẻ là
contribute	verb	/kənˈtrɪb.juːt/	To give something, especially effort or ideas, in order to help achieve something.	Đóng góp
dread (v)	verb	/dred/	To feel extremely worried or frightened about something that is going to happen.	Kinh sợ, lo lắng về điều gì đó
frustrated	adjective	/frʌsˈtreɪ.tɪd/	Feeling annoyed or less confident because you cannot achieve what you want.	Bực bội, nản lòng

impression	noun	/ɪm'preʃ.ən/	An idea, feeling, or opinion about something or someone, especially one formed without much thought.	Ấn tượng
jump to conclusions	idiom	/dʒʌmp tə kən'kluː.ʒənz/	To make a decision about something too quickly, before you have all the facts.	Vội vàng đi đến kết luận
know-it-all	noun	/'nəʊ.ɪt.ɔ:l/	A person who behaves as if they know everything.	Người tỏ ra biết tuốt
let one's guard down	idiom	/let wʌnz ɡɑ:d daʊn/	To stop being careful to avoid danger or difficulty.	Mất cảnh giác, mở lòng hơn
passionate	adjective	/'pæʃ.ən.ət/	Having very strong feelings or emotions.	Đam mê, nhiệt huyết
settle for	phrasal verb	/'set.əl fɔ:r/	To accept something that is not what you really want, but is the best available.	Chấp nhận, bằng lòng với (điều không như ý)
supportive	adjective	/sə'pɔ:.tɪv/	Giving help or encouragement.	Hay hỗ trợ, ủng hộ

Describe an impressive conversation you had that you remember well
You should say:

- **Who you talked to**
- **When and where you had the conversation**
- **What you talked about**
- **And explain why you think it was impressive**

Version 1

“This is a pretty classic university story, actually. Last year, in my statistics course, I was put in a group for a major project with a guy named Tuan. And after our first meeting, I really disliked him. He was completely silent, seemed totally uninterested, and didn't contribute a single idea. I immediately jumped to the conclusion that he was a 'free-rider' – you know, the kind of person who was going to do no work. I was pretty worried about my grade.

A few days later, feeling frustrated, I decided to just talk to him privately after class. I was kind of expecting an argument, but instead, he just looked completely exhausted. He opened up to me and explained that he was studying for a double major and was just completely swamped with assignments. He wasn't lazy; he was just burnt out.

That conversation changed everything. We decided to change our plan and play to his strengths. It turned out he was amazing at the data analysis part, just not great at brainstorming. So, we gave him all the data work, he did an incredible job, and our project turned out great.

That whole experience was a real blessing in disguise. We realized we had a lot in common and started studying together after that. Now, he's one of my closest friends on campus.”

Version 2

“Okay, so a conversation that really stuck with me was one I had about a month ago with my sociology professor, Dr. Anh. She had just given a really interesting lecture on social inequality in modern Vietnam, and it left me with a lot of questions.

I went to see her during her office hours, and honestly, I was just planning to ask a quick question about the reading material. However, the conversation quickly turned into something much deeper. We started talking about the clash between traditional values and the pressures of modern society in Vietnam today. What was amazing was that she didn't just give me answers from a textbook; she shared insights from her own research and spoke with such passion.

But the thing that made it so impressive for me was that she treated me like an equal, not just a student. She really listened to my ideas, even if they weren't fully formed, and she helped me express them better. She even recommended several extra books for me to read, things that were not on our course list.

I left her office feeling incredibly motivated and inspired. That one-hour conversation really confirmed my passion for the subject and made me see things in a new light. It was a great reminder of what university is all about – not just tests and grades, but having real, inspiring conversations like that one.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
a blessing in disguise	idiom	/əˌbles.ɪŋ m dɪsˈgaɪz/	Something that seems bad at first, but results in something good happening later.	Trong cái rủi có cái may
burnt out	adjective	/ˌbɜːnt ˈaʊt/	Feeling ill or tired because you have been working too hard.	Kiệt sức, “cháy sạch” năng lượng
clash	noun	/klæʃ/	A situation in which two people or groups of people disagree strongly.	Sự xung đột, va chạm
contribute	verb	/kənˈtrib.juːt/	To give something, especially effort or ideas, in order to help achieve something.	Đóng góp
exhausted	adjective	/ɪɡˈzɔːstɪd/	Extremely tired.	Kiệt sức, mệt lử
frustrated	adjective	/frʌsˈtreɪ.tɪd/	Feeling annoyed or less confident because you cannot achieve what you want.	Bực bội, nản lòng
insight	noun	/ˈɪn.saɪt/	A clear, deep, and sometimes sudden understanding of a complicated problem or situation.	Cái nhìn sâu sắc, sự thấu hiểu
inspired	adjective	/ɪnˈspaɪəd/	Feeling full of creative and new ideas.	Được truyền cảm hứng
jump to conclusions	idiom	/dʒʌmp tə kənˈkluː.ʒənz/	To make a decision about something too quickly, before you have all the facts.	Vội vàng đi đến kết luận
lecture	noun	/ˈlek.tʃər/	A formal talk on a serious subject given to a group of people, especially students.	Bài giảng

motivated	adjective	/'məʊ.tɪ.veɪ.tɪd/	Very enthusiastic or determined because you really want to do something.	Có động lực
open up	phrasal verb	/'əʊ.pən ʌp/	To start to talk more about yourself and your feelings.	Mở lòng, tâm sự
passion	noun	/'pæʃ.ən/	A very powerful feeling of love, enthusiasm, or desire.	Niềm đam mê
play to someone's strengths	idiom	/pleɪ tə 'sʌm.wʌnz streŋθs/	To use the skills that someone has to their full potential.	Tận dụng điểm mạnh của ai đó
social inequality	noun phrase	/,səʊ.ʃəl ɪn.ɪ'kwɒl.ə.ti/	A situation in which some groups in a society have more money, opportunities, and power than others.	Bất bình đẳng xã hội
swamped (with sth)	adjective	/swɒmpt/	Having a very large amount of something to do or deal with.	Ngập trong (công việc, bài vở)

THE
FORUM

Describe a friend of yours who is well-dressed and is good at dressing up.

You should say:

- **Who he/she is**
- **How you knew him/her**
- **What his/her dressing style is**
- **And explain why he/she dresses this way**

Version 1

“Sure, the person who immediately comes to mind is my colleague, Thao. We've been working together at the same marketing agency for about three years, and from the first day, I've always been impressed by her great sense of style. She's our team's creative director, and her style perfectly reflects her job.

Her dressing style is what I'd describe as 'smart casual', but in a very chic and effortless way. For example, she might wear a simple pair of well-fitted trousers, but she'll pair it with a unique silk blouse that has some kind of artistic print. She also has this amazing talent for choosing accessories. She'll often use just one statement piece, like a bold necklace or a beautiful watch, that makes her whole outfit look more elegant without being too flashy. Everything she wears just seems to fit her perfectly.

I think she dresses this way for a couple of reasons. Firstly, it's a big part of her personality – she's a creative person. But it's also very much a part of her professional identity. In our industry, you know, marketing and advertising, confidence and creativity are super important. The way she dresses communicates that she's both artistic and professional before she even says a word.

When she looks so put-together, it inspires confidence in both our team and our clients. So for her, I believe dressing well is a form of self-respect and also a crucial part of her job.”

Version 2

“Yeah, I can definitely talk about my friend, An. He's a graphic design student at my university, and honestly, his sense of style is just as creative as his artwork. We met in a class during our first year and became friends pretty much instantly because we both love Japanese anime.

An has a very unique and artistic style. He doesn't just follow trends; he kind of creates his own look. He often wears vintage-style clothes and is really good at playing with layers and oversized shapes. He's not afraid to be a bit dramatic, using bold patterns or bright colours that most people might shy away from. One of the coolest things is that he customizes his own clothes. For example, I've seen him wear a denim jacket with his own amazing hand-painted design on the back. When he walks across campus, he definitely turns heads.

I think the reason he dresses this way is that he sees fashion as another way to be creative, like an extension of his art. For him, what he wears is just another way to express his personality. He's not trying to show off; you can tell he's just genuinely having fun with it. He's a great example of how you don't need expensive brands to look incredibly stylish and put-together.”

THE
FORUM

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
accessory	noun	/ək'ses.ər.i/	An extra item, such as a bag, belt, or piece of jewelry, that you wear to make your clothes more attractive.	Phụ kiện
artistic	adjective	/ɑ:'tɪs.tɪk/	Showing skill and imagination in creating things; relating to art.	Có tính nghệ thuật, nghệ sĩ
chic	adjective	/ʃi:k/	Stylish and fashionable.	Sang trọng, thanh lịch
crucial	adjective	/'kruː.ʃəl/	Extremely important or necessary.	Cốt yếu, cực kỳ quan trọng
customize	verb	/'kʌs.tə.maɪz/	To change something to make it suitable for a particular person or purpose.	Tùy chỉnh, “độ” lại
effortless	adjective	/'ef.ət.ləs/	Seeming to need little or no effort; appearing very natural and easy.	Tự nhiên, không cần gắng gượng
elegant	adjective	/'el.ə.gənt/	Graceful and attractive in appearance or behavior.	Thanh lịch, tao nhã
extension	noun	/ɪk'sten.ʃən/	A part that is added to something to enlarge or prolong it.	Phần mở rộng, sự nối rộng
flashy	adjective	/'flæʃ.i/	Looking too bright, big, and expensive in a way that is intended to get attention.	Lòe loẹt, phô trương
professional identity	noun phrase	/prəˌfeʃ.ən.əl aɪ'den.tə.ti/	The way you see yourself in your professional role and how it is perceived by others.	Bản sắc nghề nghiệp

put-together	adjective	/ˌpʊt.təˈgeð.ər/	Having an appearance that is neat, well-organized, and attractive.	Chỉnh chu, gọn gàng
reflect	verb	/rɪˈflekt/	To show, express, or be a sign of something.	Phản ánh
sense of style	noun phrase	/sens əv stail/	A person's ability to choose clothes and accessories that look good together.	Gu thẩm mỹ, khiếu ăn mặc
shy away from	phrasal verb	/ʃaɪ əˈweɪ frɒm/	To avoid something that you dislike, fear, or feel unfamiliar with.	Né tránh, e ngại
statement piece	noun phrase	/ˈsteɪt.mənt piːs/	An item of clothing or jewelry that is bold and eye-catching, making a strong impact.	Món đồ tạo điểm nhấn
turn heads	idiom	/tɜːn hedz/	To attract a lot of attention because you look very good.	Khiến người khác phải ngoái nhìn

THE
FORUM

Describe an article on health you read in a magazine or on the Internet.

You should say:

- What it was
- Where you read it
- Why you read it
- And how you felt about it

Version 1

“Okay, so an article I read recently that really stuck with me was about the dangers of a 'sedentary lifestyle' – which is basically a fancy term for sitting down all day. I found it on an online health blog, I think through a link on LinkedIn.

The topic really hit home for me because, like a lot of people, I have an office job where I'm at my desk for 8 or 9 hours a day. The article explained with a lot of scientific evidence that this is incredibly bad for your health and can lead to problems like heart disease. But the part that really shocked me was its main point: that going to the gym for an hour in the evening doesn't cancel out all the damage from sitting all day. That was a real wake-up call for me, because I always assumed my workout was enough.

What made the article so great was that it offered practical solutions, not just problems. It wasn't the usual advice like 'just exercise more'. It introduced this concept called NEAT... I can't remember the full scientific name, Non-Exercise Activity... something. But the basic idea is that it's about all the energy you burn from small, everyday movements. For example, it suggested simple habits like taking the stairs, walking around while on a phone call, or just standing up to stretch every 30 minutes.

Honestly, I thought it was a brilliant article. It was well-researched but easy to understand. It totally changed my perspective. I stopped seeing exercise as this one-hour block of time and started trying to integrate small movements throughout my entire day. It's definitely made me more conscious of my daily habits.”

Version 2

“I recently read a fascinating article online that completely changed how I think about mental health. I found it on a science blog I follow called Psyche. It was all about the surprising connection between your gut health and your mental well-being, a concept they called the 'gut-brain axis'.

Basically, the article explained how the community of bacteria in our digestive system – our 'microbiome' – can directly influence our mood, our stress levels, and even how clearly we think. It explained all the complex science in a really simple and accessible way, using examples that were easy to understand. It also talked about how things that are common in a student's life – you know, stress from exams, not getting enough sleep, and eating a lot of processed food – can negatively affect this connection.

What made it such a good article for me was its practical and empowering advice. It wasn't just abstract theory. It suggested concrete things you could do, like eating more fermented foods such as yogurt and kimchi, and making sure to get enough sleep to support a healthy microbiome.

As a student who often has to deal with stress, this gave me a whole new way to think about managing my mental health – not just through my mind, but also through my body and my diet. It was a really helpful and eye-opening read.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
abstract	adjective	/ˈæb.strækt/	Based on general ideas rather than real things and events.	Trừu tượng
accessible	adjective	/əkˈses.ə.bəl/	Easy to understand.	Dễ tiếp cận, dễ hiểu
assume	verb	/əˈsju:m/	To accept something to be true without question or proof.	Cho rằng, giả định
cancel out	phrasal verb	/ˌkæn.səl ˈaʊt/	To stop something from having any effect.	Triệt tiêu, vô hiệu hóa
conscious	adjective	/ˈkɒn.jəs/	To be aware of and responding to one's surroundings.	Có ý thức, nhận thức được
empowering	adjective	/ɪmˈpaʊ.ə.rɪŋ/	Making someone stronger and more confident, especially in controlling their life.	Trao quyền, tiếp thêm sức mạnh
eye-opening	adjective	/ˈaɪ.əʊ.pən.ɪŋ/	Surprising, and teaching you new facts about life, people, etc.	Làm sáng mắt, mở mang tầm mắt
fascinating	adjective	/ˈfæs.ən.eɪ.tɪŋ/	Extremely interesting.	Hấp dẫn, lôi cuốn
hit home	idiom	/hɪt həʊm/	To cause you to realize the truth of something in a deep and emotional way.	Tác động mạnh, làm cho ai đó thấm thía
integrate	verb	/ˈɪn.tɪ.greɪt/	To combine two or more things in order to become more effective.	Tích hợp, hợp nhất
mental well-being	noun phrase	/ˌmen.təl welˈbi:.ɪŋ/	A state of happiness and contentment with life.	Sức khỏe tinh thần, sự an lạc

perspective	noun	/pə'spek.tɪv/	A particular way of considering something.	Góc nhìn, quan điểm
practical	adjective	/'præk.tɪ.kəl/	Relating to actual experience rather than ideas; useful.	Thực tế, thiết thực
sedentary	adjective	/'sed.ən.tər.i/	Involving little physical activity; tending to spend much time seated.	Ít vận động, tĩnh tại
wake-up call	noun phrase	/'weɪk.ʌp ,kɔ:l/	An event that makes you realize that there is a problem you need to do something about.	Hồi chuông cảnh tỉnh
well-researched	adjective	/,wel.rɪ'sɜ:tʃt/	Having been carefully studied and investigated.	Được nghiên cứu kỹ lưỡng

THE
FORUM

Describe an unusual but interesting building you would like to visit

You should say:

- **Where it is**
- **What it looks like**
- **Why you think it is unusual and interesting**
- **And explain why you would like to visit it**

Version 1

“Okay, so there’s a place I’ve been dying to visit, and it's not really a building in the traditional sense, but it’s an amazing piece of architecture. It’s the Golden Bridge up in Ba Na Hills, near Da Nang. I'm sure most people have seen photos of it; it's become world-famous over the last few years.

From all the pictures and videos I’ve seen, the place is just stunning. It's this beautiful golden walkway that curves along the mountainside, and the most amazing part is that it looks like it’s being held up by two giant stone hands. The hands are designed to look really old and weathered, as if they’re growing right out of the mountain. The whole concept is just incredible and looks almost unreal, like something from a fantasy movie.

I think it's so unusual and interesting because it's not just a functional bridge for walking. It's a piece of art that you can actually be inside of. It’s a perfect blend of creative design and the natural landscape around it.

I really want to visit because I want to experience that feeling of walking high up in the clouds, supported by those giant hands. I’d love to just walk slowly from one end to the other, take in the incredible panoramic view of the mountains, and of course, take tons of photos. For me, it has become a modern icon of Vietnam, showing a new, creative, and ambitious side of our country. It's more than just a bridge; it’s a destination in itself, and I find the whole idea completely fascinating.”

Version 2

“Okay, there’s one building I’ve been dying to visit for ages. It’s in Da Lat, and its real name is the Hang Nga Guesthouse, but absolutely everyone just calls it the 'Crazy House'. I’ve seen it all over social media, and it honestly looks like something straight out of a fairytale or a weird, fantasy movie.

It’s completely unique; it doesn't look like a normal building at all. The whole structure is designed to look like a giant, twisted tree. There are basically no straight lines or square corners anywhere. The staircases wind around like giant vines, the guest rooms are shaped like caves, and you'll see these bizarre statues of animals like giant spiders or bears. It just breaks all the rules of normal architecture.

If I got the chance to visit, I'd want to explore every nook and cranny. I’ve heard it’s like a maze inside, with all these strange tunnels and bridges connecting the different parts. I could easily spend hours just getting lost and taking photos of all the weird details. I’d also love to actually stay overnight in one of the themed rooms. I think there’s a 'Kangaroo Room' and a 'Tiger Room', and that would just be an unforgettable experience.

The main reason I’m so drawn to it is because it’s just pure imagination brought to life. It really challenges your idea of what a house can be. As a university student, I love anything that’s different and breaks the mould. It feels less like a functional building and more like a giant, interactive piece of art you can explore.”

Bảng tra cứu từ vựng:

Từ	Từ loại	IPA	Nghĩa trong tiếng Anh	Dịch nghĩa
architecture	n.	/ˈɑː.kɪ.tek.tʃər/	The art and practice of designing and constructing buildings.	Kiến trúc
stunning	adj.	/ˈstʌn.ɪŋ/	Extremely impressive or attractive.	Tuyệt đẹp, lộng lẫy, choáng ngợp
weathered	adj.	/ˈweð.əd/	Worn by long exposure to the atmosphere; looking old.	Dãi dầu sương gió, cũ kỹ do thời tiết
functional	adj.	/ˈfʌŋk.ʃən.əl/	Designed to be practical and useful rather than attractive.	Hữu dụng, có tính công năng
blend	n.	/blend/	A mixture of different things or qualities that combine together well.	Sự pha trộn, sự kết hợp
panoramic	adj.	/ˌpæn.ərˈæm.ɪk/	With a view of a wide area of land.	Toàn cảnh, bao quát
icon	n.	/ˈaɪ.kɒn/	A person or thing regarded as a representative symbol of something.	Biểu tượng
ambitious	adj.	/æmˈbɪʃ.əs/	Having a strong desire and determination to succeed; showing imagination.	Hoài bão, tham vọng, táo bạo

unique	adj.	/ju:'ni:k/	Being the only one of its kind; unlike anything else.	Độc đáo, độc nhất vô nhị
structure	n.	/'strʌk.tʃər/	The arrangement of and relations between the parts of something complex.	Cấu trúc, công trình
twisted	adj.	/'twɪs.tɪd/	Forced out of its natural or proper shape; contorted.	Xoắn, vặn vẹo
bizarre	adj.	/bɪ'zɑ:r/	Very strange or unusual.	Kỳ quái, kỳ dị, kỳ lạ
nook and cranny	idiom	/nʊk ənd 'kræ.n.i/	Every part of a place; every small corner and hiding place.	Mọi góc ngách
unforgettable	adj.	/,ʌn.fə'get.ə.bəl/	Impossible to forget; very memorable.	Không thể quên, đáng nhớ
break the mould	idiom	/breɪk ðə məʊld/	To do something differently after it has been done in the same way for a long time.	Phá vỡ khuôn mẫu, đi ngược lại lối mòn
interactive	adj.	/,ɪn.tər'æk.tɪv/	Allowing a two-way flow of information between a system and a user; involving communication.	Có tính tương tác